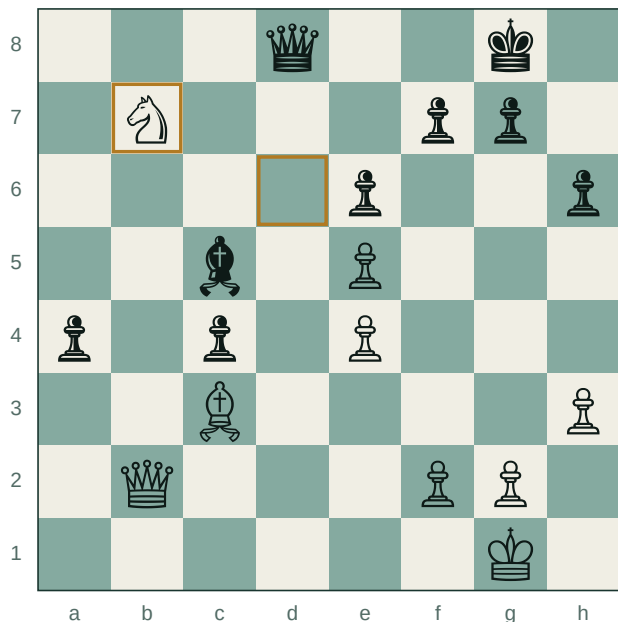


# Active defensive resources: Black, move 38

Active defensive resources

Black to move



Previous move: 38.Nb7. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

**WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST**

**38...Qd1+ 39. Kh2 a3 40. Qa1 Qxa1 41. Bxa1 Bb4**

**38...Qd1+** Check restricts White to 2 legal replies here. Recorded reply: **39.Kh2**.

**39...a3** The pawn moves from a4 to a3. Recorded reply: **40.Qa1**.

**40...Qxa1** The queen captures the queen on a1. Recorded reply: **41.Bxa1**.

**41...Bb4** The bishop moves from c5 to b4.

At the end, nominal material is White 11 / Black 9 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, Black's balance changes by +0. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

## CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does Black's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** +0: the balance goes from -2 to -2. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

## CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

A defensive puzzle may aim to preserve equality rather than win. Judge success against the threat, not only the final material count.

## WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

The best defense may create a threat, exchange an attacker, or change the geometry of the attack. Identify the opponent's concrete idea before selecting a response.

## HOW TO LOOK

Name the threatened move and the conditions it requires. Look for a move that breaks one of those conditions with tempo.

The defending king is on g1. Absolute pin: pawn on f2.